Shayan Hajhashemi

World models · Representation learning · Dynamical systems and control

McGill University · Montréal, Canada Mila profile

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Research profile

Machine learning researcher working on predictive representations, system identification, and differentiable simulation of nonlinear dynamics. Research spans multimodal world models, learned inverse solvers, and constrained optimal control. Interested in action-conditioned representations and reliable world models for robot learning and planning. Seeking research internships and full-time research roles.

Education

McGill University — PhD, Quantitative Life Sciences Expected 2026

Supervisors: Morgan Craig and Amin Emad. Research in scientific machine learning, nonlinear dynamics, and control.

McGill University — BSc (Honours), Interdepartmental Immunology 2021

Honours research: Turing patterns, reaction–diffusion systems, and cell motility; supervisor: Anmar Khadra.

Selected research

Multimodal world models: alignment, prediction, and control *AISTATS 2027 submission*

- Co-developed concepts for representation alignment and nonlinear model predictive control (NMPC) in multimodal world models; contributed to theoretical analysis.
- Implemented and audited controlled-Lorenz experiments in PyTorch, comparing cross-modal prediction, contrastive alignment, and inverse-dynamics regularization under latent-goal model predictive control: 80 fits and 4,208 control trials across five training seeds.

WAR: adaptive regularization for system identification *AISTATS 2027 submission*

- Combined learned temporal-window selection and adaptive regularization with differentiable constrained weak-form solvers; used variable projection for nonlinear parameter inference from noisy observations.
- Ranked first overall among eight methods on 1,200 held-out systems across six ODE families, evaluating parameter and trajectory recovery separately. Tested sensitivity to noise and sparse or irregular sampling.

OIL: learning initializers through downstream optimization *ICLR 2027 submission*

- Trained message-passing initializers through five differentiable trajectory-matching updates, with losses on initial parameters, refined parameters, and simulated trajectories; used bounded optimization at inference.
- Evaluated inverse methods on 100,000 simulated systems at each of three system sizes using five-fold validation. Analyzed sensitivity geometry, rollout failures, posterior diagnostics, and matched optimization budgets.

DiffDose: differentiable optimal control *Preprint; under review*

- Optimized bounded dose amplitudes and administration times through differentiable ODE and delay-equation simulations. Compared automatic differentiation with analytic adjoints and finite differences for open-loop control.

Latent-space dynamics and representation learning *Preprint*

- Coauthored a variational framework coupling learned cell-state representations to potential-gradient neural ODEs for trajectory and cell-fate prediction.

Manuscripts and preprints

1. **Hajhashemi, S.**; Shum-Tim, C.; Craig, M.; Emad, A. *WAR: Weak-form Adaptive Regularization for Dynamical Systems Inverse Problems.* Submitted 7 October 2026. Under review at *AISTATS 2027*.

2. **Hajhashemi, S.**; Shum-Tim, C.; Prakash, S.; Emad, A. *Predators, Prey, and Sloppy Parameters: Fine-Tuning Amortized Inference for Generalized Lotka–Volterra.* Submitted 18 September 2026. Under review at *ICLR 2027*. **Co-first author.**

3. Ramezanian-Panahi, M.; **Hajhashemi, S.**; Rish, I. *Multimodal World Models: Alignment, Prediction, and Control.* Submitted 7 October 2026. Under review at *AISTATS 2027*.

4. **Hajhashemi, S.**; Emad, A.; Craig, M. *DiffDose: Differentiable Programming for Personalized Dose-Regimen Optimal Control.* Submitted 13 September 2026. bioRxiv DOI: 10.64898/2026.09.07.749974. Under review at *npj Systems Biology and Applications*.

5. Poursina, A.; **Hajhashemi, S.**; Mikaeili Namini, A.; Saberi, A.; Emad, A.; Najafabadi, H. S. *A Latent Space Thermodynamic Model of Cell Differentiation.* Submitted 6 March 2026. bioRxiv DOI: 10.64898/2026.03.04.709512. Under review at *Nature Computational Science*.

6. Lemaire, V.; **Hajhashemi, S.**; Rotte, A.; Seyed-Ahmadi, A.; Tripathi, S.; Chanu, P.; Wu, B.; Li, C.; Ramanujan, S.; Gadkar, K.; Jin, J. *Explainability analysis of QSP-derived virtual populations identifies robust pre-treatment biomarkers of immunotherapy.* Submitted 11 September 2025. Under review at *npj Precision Oncology*.

Auxiliary publications

7. Dhoparee-Doomah, I.; Ma, K.; Brassard, A.; Leo, S.; **Hajhashemi, S.**; …; Cools-Lartigue, J. *RORγ Inverse Agonism Redirects Tumour-Conditioned Emergency Myelopoiesis and Attenuates Established Tumour Progression.* 7 October 2026. bioRxiv, version 1. DOI: 10.64898/2026.10.01.755741. Under review at *Cancer Discovery*.

8. Dhoparee-Doomah, I.; Li, Y.; Al Dow, M.; **Hajhashemi, S.**; …; Cools-Lartigue, J. *A Measurable Systemic Immune Phenotype Links Circulating Myeloid Dysfunction to Tumour Spatial Organization in Gastroesophageal Adenocarcinoma.* 18 September 2026. bioRxiv, version 1. DOI: 10.64898/2026.09.17.752366.

9. Roche, P.; **Hajhashemi, S.**; Akavia, U. D. (2020). *Nanobody administration of Cas9 improves nuclear localization and HDR-enhanced synthetic lethality in A549 lung carcinoma.* Withdrawn for intellectual property reasons. Jenthera Therapeutics.

Full author lists and patent: shayshay42.github.io/publications.html.

Research experience

Genentech — Modeling & Simulations Intern 2024–2025
Supervisor: Vincent Lemaire; San Francisco, USA.

- Trained conditional generative models using flow matching and optimal transport for simulator-derived virtual populations; applied learned distributions to biomarker analysis.

Earlier research: Consultant Research Scientist, Jenthera Therapeutics (2020–2021); Research Associate, Goodman Cancer Research Center (2019–2020). Experimental nanobody research and image analysis.

Selected technical projects

Robot manipulation in simulation — Independent prototype

- Built training and evaluation scripts for simulated manipulation with MuJoCo, robosuite, Gymnasium, and Stable-Baselines3; explored soft actor–critic and behavior cloning from demonstrations.

Representation learning for dynamical systems and graphs — McGill, 2021–2022

- Explored time-series embeddings using Transformers, LSTM autoencoders, Fourier and wavelet features for novelty search; studied relational graph convolutional embeddings and structural comparison of 3D RNA motifs.

Technical skills

Programming: Python, Julia, MATLAB; PyTorch, JAX/diffrax, Pyro, Julia SciML.
Methods: Neural ODEs, graph neural networks, system identification, differentiable optimization, variational inference, flow matching, sensitivity analysis, model predictive control.
Simulation projects: MuJoCo, robosuite, Gymnasium, Stable-Baselines3; reinforcement and imitation learning experiments.

Invited and accepted presentations

- **Hajhashemi, S.** *Real-MVP: Virtual Populations As Simulation-Based Conditional Neural Densities.* SIAM Conference on the Life Sciences, Cleveland, Ohio, 6 July 2026. Invited oral presentation at an international conference. MS11: Recent Advances in Digital Twins and Trial Simulations to Guide Clinical Decisions.
- Shum-Tim, C.; **Hajhashemi, S.** *Weak-Form Distillation for Label-Free PDE Inverse Problems.* World Modeling for Physics Workshop, Aspen Center for Physics, Aspen, Colorado, 28 February–5 March 2027. **Accepted oral presentation; upcoming.**

Teaching and service

Teaching: Scientific Machine Learning and ODEs in Julia, workshop instructor (2023); graduate nonlinear dynamics and computational methods, teaching assistant (2022).
Service: Julia conference reviewer (2024).

Selected awards

NSERC CGS-D (2023–2026); FRQ-Santé doctoral scholarship (awarded 2023–2026); department three-minute thesis winner (2022); Dean's Multidisciplinary First Class Honours (2019–2021).